

to see what we were doing. Unfortunately we set up our latrine in the same corner of the complex and the kids found it unbelievably humorous to sneak peaks at the crapping American soldiers. That's disgusting if you ask me, especially since many of us now have "Saddam's Revenge," an unusually brutal case of the stomach flu.

Speaking of the old "Revenge," I had it for the last four days—I finally recovered today. It was hell! I was shitting every 30 minutes at least, day and night. I get a sudden rumble in my stomach and then I would basically have to run to the crapper before I sprayed dirty-shit water all over the place. Good Grief! Now half of everyone here either has it, or has had it in the last few days. I finally got over it last night after taking 4 days worth of Immodium AD and a slew of other medication provided by the medics. I will tell you that, as a bonus, when the diarrhea finally went away it was followed by the worst headache that I have had in a long time as a result of the dehydration. Whew, I am glad that is over and done with. I have now found respect for dysentery and would never wish it on anyone. I don't want to gross you out too much so I won't elaborate on all the nitty-gritty details. I just want to add one final note: the discomfort was definitely made worse by not having a regular flushing toilet. The tin bucket we had in its place simply did not offer the same level of service—and the flies loved it! Lt. Collins complained about the one horsefly that hung around in the bucket. It seems this fly's favorite hobby was to wait for someone in desperate need to come and squat so that he could fly up and bite you in the nuts. Fucking Great!

Well that seems to be the round up. Today Major Cribb told me that I was doing a good job, which is always nice to hear even though I haven't felt like I have had too much of a job period. That may finally change though. Since we have taken over a new sector, we are now responsible for several projects at the local university. One of our battle captains will be responsible for leading those efforts, leaving Lt. Sproesser and myself to become the new Battle Captains. At least I will be responsible for some sort of information management rather than answering radios. Since I can't come home, I will take this and hope to do my best.

Thank you for your letter and the picture. I love to receive your letters. I wish you a safe return to Ft. Riley and hope that you find everything in order when you return (not to mention a few of my letters that I have sent). I love you always and I can't wait to come home again.

Love,

A handwritten signature in cursive script, appearing to read "Christian", with a long horizontal flourish extending to the right.

Christian